🗳️ Women's Suffrage: Reading

US History · Unit 8 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · our own reading

Name: _____



Inez Milholland leads the 1913 suffrage parade

Winning the Vote

For most of U.S. history, women could not vote. Many people believed women belonged at home, not in politics.

In 1848, Elizabeth Cady Stanton and Lucretia Mott led a meeting at **Seneca Falls**, New York. They wrote that “all men and women are created equal.”

Susan B. Anthony spent more than 50 years organizing. In 1872 she cast a ballot in Rochester, New York, was arrested and fined $100, and never paid. She died in 1906, fourteen years before the amendment named for her passed.

Western territories and states such as Wyoming (1869) and Utah gave women the vote first. Carrie Chapman Catt's “Winning Plan” combined state campaigns with pressure on Congress for a federal amendment.

Alice Paul used bolder ways: a big **parade** in 1913 and the Silent Sentinels at the White House. Some women were jailed and went on hunger strike.

World War I changed minds. Women filled factory, farm and nursing jobs, and suffragists asked how the U.S. could fight for democracy abroad while denying it to women at home. President Wilson endorsed the amendment in 1918.

Congress passed the 19th Amendment in 1919, and Tennessee became the 36th state to ratify it in August 1920. Still, many Black, Native American and Asian American women faced other barriers to voting for decades.

Check your reading

1. How did the strategies of Catt and Paul work together to win the vote?

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2. Explain the argument suffragists made about democracy during WWI.

3. Why does the reading say the fight was not over in 1920?